

Competitive Moat Analysis

Teacat · Indie Vibe Coding Funding Platform

Solana On-Chain Verification Model · \$5 Micro-Tip Architecture · Zero Regulatory Exposure · Wallet Reputation Moat

Built on Helius RPC · Permissionless P2P transfers · Teacat as reputation layer, not payment processor

April 2026

Executive Summary

Teacat is a reputation and campaign discovery layer built on top of the Solana blockchain. Funders send SOL or USDC directly to builder wallets — permissionless, peer-to-peer — and Teacat uses Helius RPC nodes to verify on-chain that funding events occurred, updating campaign state accordingly. Teacat never touches the money. This architecture has three compounding strategic consequences: near-zero regulatory exposure, sub-cent transaction costs, and cryptographically verifiable trust that no Web2 platform can replicate.

At a \$5 per-donor micro-tip cap, the product sits in the high-frequency / low-value funding tier. This is structurally different from Kickstarter (one-off campaign) or Patreon (subscription). The moat must therefore be built on volume, wallet reputation, and community identity rather than payment infrastructure or escrow mechanics.

Dimension	Teacat Today	Key Gap vs. Leaders	Opportunity
Network Effects	Early / weak	No liquidity flywheel	Quadratic-Lite matching pool
Community Depth	Niche aligned	No recognition system	Builder leagues
Trust / Identity	Basic	No wallet reputation layer	On-chain wallet scores
Switching Costs	Low	No proprietary data retained	Funding history indexing
Regulatory Exposure	Near zero	None — structural advantage	Maintain permissionless model

Bottom line: The on-chain architecture is Teacat's most defensible structural advantage — it cannot be replicated by Web2 platforms without fundamental rebuilds. The five strategies in this report are designed to compound that foundation into switching costs, community identity, and data moats that reinforce each other over time.

1. Helius, "Solana Leading RPC and API Platform", <https://www.helius.dev>

2. Hashnode, "State of Vibe Coding 2026", <https://hashnode.com/blog/state-of-vibe-coding-2026>

1. The Teacat Model — Architecture & Positioning

Teacat connects indie vibe coding builders — solo developers using AI tools like Lovable, Bolt, Cursor, and Replit — with crowdfunders who back micro-products directly on-chain. Three architectural choices define it against every competitor in this analysis:

- \$5 per-donor micro-tip cap. The funding model is high-frequency and low-value. Many small funders backing many small builders creates a democratic, community-driven signal that mirrors Bitcoin's quadratic funding philosophy — without requiring crypto expertise from users.
- Permissionless on-chain transfers. Funders send SOL or USDC directly to builder wallets. No escrow, no intermediary, no custody. Teacat reads Helius RPC nodes to confirm transactions occurred on-chain and updates campaign state accordingly. This means Teacat is legally an information platform, not a payment processor.
- Zero platform fee. Because Teacat never touches funds, there is no economic basis for a platform cut. Solana transaction fees are fractions of a cent,³ making this the most cost-efficient funding model in the competitive set by a wide margin.

The Solana choice is strategically significant beyond fees. Solana processed 518,000 daily transactions vs Base's 505,000 in January 2026, is the dominant chain for AI agent micropayments (67% of x402 transactions in Q3 2025),⁴ and the Solana Foundation launched payments.org in February 2026 — signalling institutional commitment to the micro-payment stack that Teacat would sit on top of.

What Teacat is not: It is not an escrow service, a payment institution, a CASP under MiCA, or a money transmitter under UK PSRs. The permissionless P2P transfer model and pure verification role places Teacat outside all five CASP service categories defined under MiCA (custody, exchange, trading on behalf of others, portfolio advice, payments).⁵

3. Fystack, "Why Solana Is Emerging as a Leading Chain for Payments 2026",

<https://fystack.io/blog/why-solana-is-emerging-as-a-leading-chain-for-global-payments>

4. Fystack, Solana micropayments data, same source.

5. Narvi, "What is MiCA Crypto Regulation? 2025 Update", <https://narvi.com/blog/mica-eu-regulation>

2. Platform-by-Platform Competitive Analysis

Ten platforms were assessed across five moat dimensions with scoring adjusted to reflect Teacat's on-chain, \$5 micro-tip model. Scores are 1–5 where 5 = strongest moat relative to Teacat's specific competitive context. Fee data sourced from official platform documentation as of April 2026.

Platform	Fee Structure	Network Effects	Community Strength	Trust / Identity	Switching Costs	Data Advantage	Total /25
Kickstarter	5% + 3–5% proc.	4	3	3	2	3	15
Indiegogo*	5% + ~3% proc.	3	2	2	2	2	11
Patreon	10% + ~3% proc.	3	4	2	3	3	15
BuyMeACoffee	5% flat	2	3	1	2	2	10
Ko-fi	0–5%	2	3	1	2	2	10
Gumroad	10% + \$0.50/tx	2	2	1	2	2	9
Gitcoin	~0% (QF model)	5	4	5	2	4	20
GitHub Sponsors	0% (sub.)	4	4	3	2	3	16
Open Collective	5–8% host fee	3	3	3	3	3	15
Product Hunt	Free / discovery	3	3	1	1	2	10
TEACAT (today)	0% / on-chain	2	3	2	1	1	9
TEACAT (target)	0% / on-chain	4	5	5	4	4	22

* Indiegogo acquired by Gamefound (July 2025), discontinued flexible funding model.⁶

Kickstarter

5% platform fee + 3–5% Stripe processing. All-or-nothing model. Strong brand trust moat — 'successfully funded on Kickstarter' is a credibility signal, but it is poorly suited to 2–8 week vibe code sprint cycles and imposes ~\$100 minimum campaign friction.

Key weakness vs. Teacat: No on-chain verification; no developer community; minimum campaign overhead eliminates micro-projects.

Source: [SendfromChina Fee Guide](#)

Patreon

Standardised 10% fee for new creators as of August 2025. Strong subscription community moat but no project-based funding mode. Fee increase (from 5–12% tiered) risks creator migration. At \$5 micro-tip level, Patreon's effective fee is 18–25% on small transactions.

Key weakness vs. Teacat: No on-chain verification; no developer identity; heavy iOS App Store 30% exposure.

Source: [Ruzuku Patreon Pricing Analysis](#)

Ko-fi

0% on tips, 5% on sales/memberships. Bootstrapped, avoids investor monetisation pressure. Good community feel but no developer-specific identity, no on-chain capability, and basic analytics only.

Key weakness vs. Teacat: No wallet/on-chain support; no builder verification; no network effects for discovery.

Source: [Productmint Ko-fi Analysis](#)

BuyMeACoffee

Flat 5% on all transactions plus processing. VC-backed with investor pressure to monetise. The closest Web2 analogue to Teacat's tip model but with no on-chain capability, no developer identity layer, and higher effective cost.

Key weakness vs. Teacat: No crypto/on-chain support; no developer identity; 5% cut Teacat avoids entirely.

Source: [SchoolMaker BMC Pricing](#)

Gumroad

10% + \$0.50 per transaction. No community layer, purely transactional. High creator churn at scale. No on-chain capability. Teacat's Solana model is approximately 20x cheaper per transaction.

Key weakness vs. Teacat: Most expensive model for growing creators; no community or on-chain trust signals.

Source: [CheckThat Gumroad Pricing](#)

Gitcoin

The strongest competitive analogue. Operates quadratic funding on EVM chains via Allo Protocol — \$60M+ distributed to 3,700+ projects.⁷ Gitcoin Passport provides robust Sybil resistance via on-chain identity stamps. Gitcoin 3.0 (2025) decentralises round operations. Critical differentiator: Gitcoin targets Ethereum public goods, not commercial Solana micro-products.

Key weakness vs. Teacat: Ethereum-native (Teacat is Solana); targets OSS/public goods not commercial products; requires crypto fluency.

Source: [Gitcoin Quadratic Funding](#)

GitHub Sponsors

0% fee (GitHub absorbs processing for first year). \$40M+ distributed, 4,200+ developers across 103 regions.⁸ Deep workflow integration — sponsorship buttons on repos. Strong switching cost for GitHub-native builders.

Key weakness vs. Teacat: Individual developer sponsorship only — no project-based crowdfunding; no on-chain verification.

Source: [GitHub Sponsors](#)

Open Collective

5–8% fiscal host fee. Transparent spending, all income/expenses public. Moving toward DAO governance with Bitcoin integration (Spring 2025). Complex onboarding for solo builders; slow fund disbursement.

Key weakness vs. Teacat: Web2 infrastructure; no on-chain capability; too complex for rapid vibe coding project cycles.

Source: [Open Collective](#)

Indiegogo

Acquired by Gamefound July 2025. Discontinued flexible funding October 2025. Now all-or-nothing only, narrowing relevance. Integration with tabletop gaming ecosystem makes it a poor fit for software micro-projects.

Key weakness vs. Teacat: Declining relevance for software; governance change created creator uncertainty.

Source: [Fundpop Comparison](#)

Product Hunt

Free discovery platform — no direct funding. Strong launch signal but attention is ephemeral. A complementary channel for Teacat builders rather than a competitor. No financial infrastructure, no on-chain capability.

Key weakness vs. Teacat: Not a funding platform; no KYC or wallet identity; community engagement does not persist.

Source: [Product Hunt](#)

6. LaunchBoom, "Indiegogo vs Kickstarter 2026", <https://www.launchboom.com/crowdfunding-guides/indiegogo-vs-kickstarter-whats-the-difference/>
7. Gitcoin, "Quadratic Funding", <https://gitcoin.co/mechanisms/quadratic-funding>
8. GitHub, "GitHub Sponsors", <https://github.com/open-source/sponsors>

3. Competitive Positioning Matrix

The matrix plots all eleven platforms on two axes: Builder Niche Depth & Vibe Coder Focus (how well the platform serves the specific indie vibe coding cohort) versus Trust Moat Strength (durability of the platform's competitive defence). Teacat's on-chain architecture gives it the highest niche focus score in the set — no other platform is explicitly built for Solana-native vibe coding builder funding.

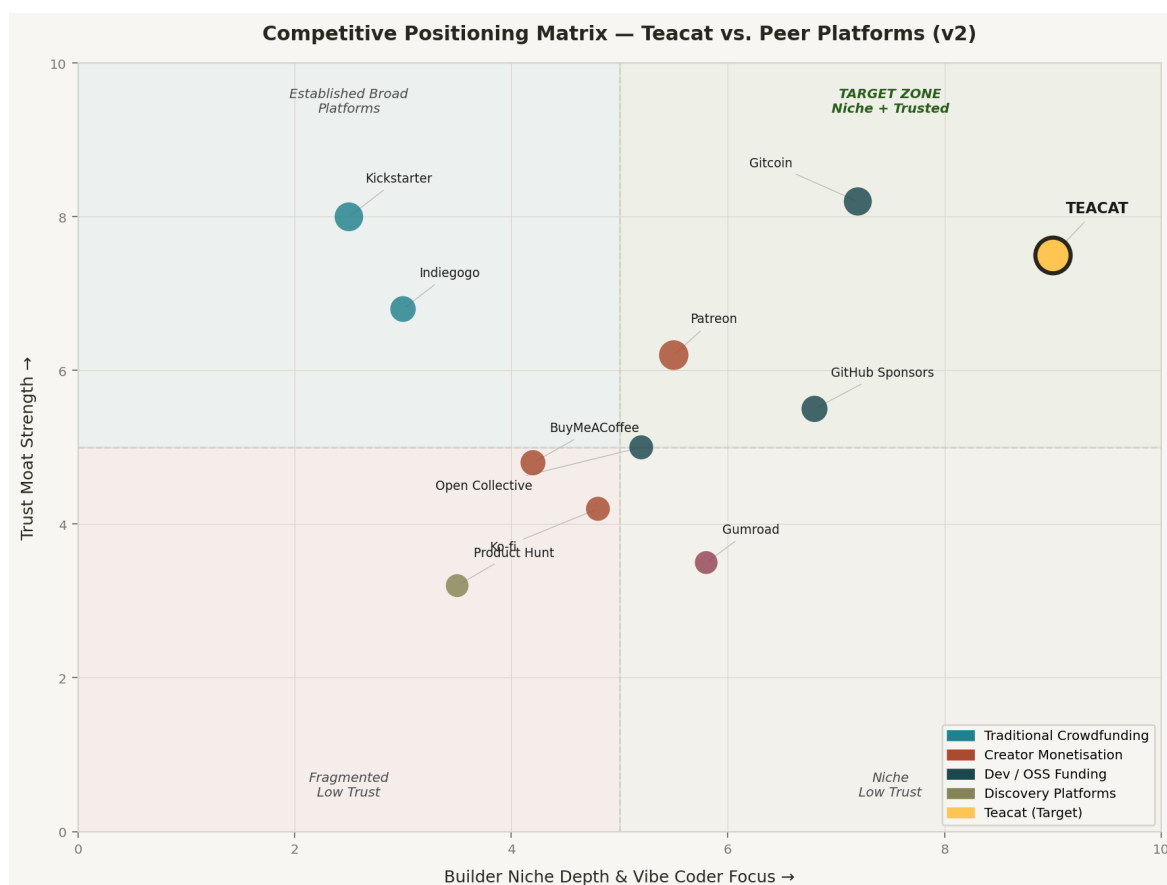


Figure 1. Competitive Positioning Matrix v2. Teacat's target trajectory is the upper-right quadrant. The 'TEACAT (target)' score of 22/25 is achievable within 18 months via the five strategies in Section 4.

Key observations:

- Gitcoin is the closest analogue in trust and network moat, but is Ethereum-native and targets public goods — the Solana commercial micro-product space is entirely open.
- All Web2 tip platforms (Ko-fi, BuyMeACoffee) score identically low on trust/identity — none have wallet verification or on-chain history. Teacat's on-chain model is structurally differentiated, not just competitively differentiated.
- GitHub Sponsors has the strongest switching cost for OSS builders but cannot serve the commercial vibe coder building micro-SaaS products on Solana.
- Teacat today sits at 9/25 — competitive parity with BuyMeACoffee and Ko-fi. The gap to close is not on fees (already won) but on trust, network effects, and data.

4. Five Prioritised Moat-Building Strategies

Strategies are revised for the on-chain, \$5 micro-tip architecture. eKYC is replaced by wallet reputation scoring. The escrow-based trust mechanism is replaced by cryptographic proof-of-transfer. Strategies are ordered by near-term ROI and feasibility.

Strategy 01 — Vibe Coder Identity Layer (On-Chain)

Moat Dimension: Trust Mechanisms + Community Strength

A Solana-native builder identity system using on-chain history as the credential — no eKYC needed.

Problem: Trust is the top barrier in micro-crowdfunding. Funders need to know a builder has shipped before. Traditional platforms use brand reputation (Kickstarter's all-or-nothing model) or manual review. In the vibe coding market, 170 out of 1,645 Lovable apps had security vulnerabilities in 2025⁹ — eroding funder confidence in AI-built products specifically.

Solution: Build a Teacat Builder Identity system using Helius RPC to index builder wallet history: (1) Ship Score — campaigns funded on-chain and subsequently delivered, calculated from wallet activity patterns; (2) Wallet Reputation Integration — pull scores from Nomis or ChainAware's Solana API (both offer programmatic access to wallet reputation scores across 50+ on-chain signals¹⁰) to establish builder legitimacy without requiring any ID documents; (3) Tool Stack Badge — tags indicating which vibe tools were used (Lovable, Bolt, Cursor), making campaigns more legible to tech-savvy funders; (4) Funding History NFT — optional minted credential on Solana Attestation Service proving on-chain that a builder has successfully funded previous projects.

Key Metrics	Campaign completion rate (funded → delivered); funder repeat backing rate per builder
Effort	Low–Medium
Target Timeline	Q2–Q3 2026

Strategy 02 — Builder Leagues

Moat Dimension: Network Effects + Switching Costs

A four-tier reputation layer that makes leaving Teacat costly by forfeiting earned on-chain league status.

Problem: At \$5 per funder, a builder's income depends entirely on volume — many funders backing repeatedly across many projects. There is currently no mechanism that incentivises builders to run their next project on Teacat rather than moving to Ko-fi or Product Hunt. GitHub Sponsors captures repeat builders through audience lock-in; Teacat needs an equivalent.

Solution: Implement Builder Leagues — four tiers (Seed → Growth → Momentum → Elite) based on cumulative on-chain funding milestones verified by Helius, funder retention rates, and project delivery scores. League status is publicly displayed on builder profiles and earns: higher placement in Teacat's discovery feed, early access to Boost Rounds (Strategy 5), and referral multipliers. Critically, league status is anchored to the builder's Teacat profile — it is not portable to competing platforms, and the on-chain funding history that feeds it is indexed exclusively by Teacat's Helius integration. The data is public, but the interpretation is Teacat-proprietary.

Key Metrics	Builder 90-day retention rate; average on-chain funding rounds per builder per year
Effort	Medium
Target Timeline	Q3 2026

Strategy 03 — Wallet Reputation Funder Scores

Moat Dimension: Trust Mechanisms + Data Advantage

Replace eKYC entirely with on-chain wallet reputation — zero friction, cryptographically grounded trust.

Problem: The original report recommended eKYC for funder verification. At \$5 per transaction, this is over-engineered and creates friction that kills conversion. However, the trust problem is real: builders cannot distinguish genuine supporters from Sybil attackers or bots in a permissionless system.

Solution: Integrate a Solana wallet reputation API (Nomis, ChainAware, or Fairscale — all offer Solana-native scoring¹¹) at the point of funder wallet connection. Wallets are automatically scored on 10+ on-chain parameters including transaction history, protocol diversity, wallet age, and fraud probability. Funders above a minimum reputation threshold receive a Verified Wallet badge — no ID documents, no friction beyond connecting their existing Solana wallet. This badge makes funder reputation a Teacat-native asset: it reflects Teacat's specific scoring model and methodology, even though the underlying data is on-chain. Wallets with 98%+ fraud probability are automatically filtered.¹²

Key Metrics	Sybil attack rate on campaigns; average donation per verified vs. unverified wallet
Effort	Low
Target Timeline	Q2–Q3 2026

Strategy 04 — Funding History Intelligence Dashboard

Moat Dimension: Data Advantage + Switching Costs

Teacat's Helius indexing creates proprietary intelligence about the vibe coding funding cycle that no competitor can replicate.

Problem: All on-chain data is public — but raw Solana transaction data is not human-readable or actionable. Teacat's value is in the interpretation layer built on top of Helius indexing: which wallet types fund which types of projects, what optimal campaign timing looks like for 2–8 week vibe coding sprints, and when a campaign is underperforming vs. similar projects. No existing platform has this dataset because the vibe coding cohort did not exist at scale until 2025.

Solution: Build a builder-facing analytics dashboard that surfaces: (1) Funder wallet cohort curves — which wallet reputation tiers return for a second project; (2) Category affinity maps — which funder wallets historically back which types of Solana tools; (3) Campaign timing recommendations — optimal launch windows based on indexed on-chain activity patterns; (4) Comparative benchmarks — how a live campaign compares to similar historical campaigns in the Teacat index. This intelligence is platform-exclusive even though the underlying transactions are public. A builder who migrates to Ko-fi loses this benchmarking entirely.

Key Metrics	Weekly dashboard active usage rate; funding delta for campaigns using intelligence vs. without
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Effort	Medium–High
Target Timeline	Q4 2026–Q1 2027

Strategy 05 — Quadratic-Lite Matching Pool (Solana-Native)

Moat Dimension: Network Effects + Data Advantage

A Gitcoin-inspired QF matching mechanism adapted for Solana commercial micro-products — filling the gap Gitcoin deliberately leaves.

Problem: Gitcoin's quadratic funding is its strongest moat — the matching pool structurally incentivises many small funders, amplifying community signal. But Gitcoin is deliberately scoped to Ethereum public goods, not commercial products. At \$5 per funder, the QF formula (matching proportional to the square root of individual contributions) is mathematically ideal: a campaign with $100 \times \$5$ funders receives far more matching than one with $1 \times \$500$ funder, rewarding community breadth over whale concentration.

Solution: Launch quarterly Teacat Boost Rounds: a Solana-native matching pool funded by dev tool sponsors (Lovable, Bolt, Cursor, Replit) or VCs scouting early-stage products. Sponsors fund the pool in USDC on-chain; Teacat's smart contract calculates QF allocations transparently; Helius confirms all distributions. Builders with many small on-chain backers receive proportionally more from the pool. This creates four compounding effects: new funder acquisition (funders know their \$5 has amplified impact), recurring platform events (quarterly rounds drive return visits), sponsor discovery pipeline (access to Teacat builder data), and proof-of-work for the on-chain intelligence layer (Strategy 4). Sponsoring dev tool companies gain first look at what vibe coders are building — a monetisation model that preserves the zero-fee promise to builders entirely.

Key Metrics	Boost round participation rate; new wallet acquisition per round; sponsor renewal rate
Effort	High
Target Timeline	Q1 2027

9. Hashnode, security findings 2025, <https://hashnode.com/blog/state-of-vibe-coding-2026>

10. ChainAware, "Web3 Reputation Score Comparison 2026",

<https://chainaware.ai/blog/web3-reputation-score-comparison-2026/>

11. Solana Compass, "Top Reputation Systems on Solana", <https://solanacompass.com/projects/category/governance/reputation>

12. ChainAware, fraud probability scoring, same source as [10].

5. Implementation Roadmap

Three phases ordered to establish on-chain identity first (Phase 1), compound into data intelligence (Phase 2), then activate the network flywheel (Phase 3).

Initiative	Phase	Quarter	Primary Moat	Dependency	Success Metric
Helius RPC Integration	1 · Foundation	Q2 2026	Trust	None	100% campaigns verified on-chain
Vibe Coder Identity Layer	1 · Foundation	Q2 2026	Trust	Helius live	50% builders with Ship Score
Wallet Reputation Scores	1 · Foundation	Q3 2026	Trust	Nomis/ChainAware API	Bot attack rate < 1%
Builder Leagues (Seed-Growth)	1 · Foundation	Q3 2026	Switching Costs	Identity Layer	60% builder 90d retention
Intelligence Dashboard v1	2 · Acceleration	Q4 2026	Data Advantage	Leagues live	40% weekly dashboard use
Builder Leagues (Momentum-Elite)	2 · Acceleration	Q4 2026	Switching Costs	6mo league data	20% builders at Elite tier
Intelligence Dashboard v2	3 · Flywheel	Q1 2027	Data Advantage	6mo analytics data	10% funding lift vs. no-analytics
Quadratic-Lite Matching Pool	3 · Flywheel	Q1 2027	Network Effects	Sponsor partnerships	500+ wallets per Boost Round
Sponsor Programme	3 · Flywheel	Q1-Q2 2027	Revenue	Boost Round prototype	2 anchor sponsors signed

Phase Summary

Phase	Q	Focus	Core Deliverable
1 · Foundation	Q2–Q3 2026	Trust & On-Chain Identity	Helius integration + Vibe Coder ID + Wallet Scores + Seed Leagues
2 · Acceleration	Q4 2026	Data & Retention	Intelligence Dashboard + Momentum/Elite League tiers
3 · Flywheel	Q1–Q2 2027	Network Effects + Revenue	Matching Pool + Corporate Dev Tool Sponsors

6. Regulatory Position — On-Chain Model

The on-chain verification architecture materially reduces Teacat's regulatory exposure compared to any escrow or payment intermediary model. This section documents the legal basis for that position.

EU — MiCA (in force December 2024)

MiCA defines five service categories requiring CASP licensing: custody/administration, operating an exchange, trading on behalf of others, portfolio advice, and payment services.¹³ Teacat does not perform any of these. The platform reads on-chain state via Helius RPC and updates a campaign UI — this is an information service, not a crypto asset service. The Solana Foundation's launch of payments.org (February 2026) further establishes that on-chain payment rails are infrastructure, and applications built on top are not inherently CASPs.

UK — PSRs 2017 (PSD2 equivalent)

UK Payment Services Regulations require authorisation for firms that receive, hold, or transmit funds. Teacat does none of these — funds move directly between funder and builder wallets without Teacat involvement. The FCA's guidance on crypto assets distinguishes between firms that have 'control over' crypto assets and those that merely provide information about transactions. Teacat falls firmly in the latter category.

FATF / Travel Rule — Single Risk to Monitor

The FATF Travel Rule (and its EU TFR implementation) requires CASPs to attach sender/receiver identity information to crypto transfers. This applies to CASPs, not information platforms. However, if Teacat were ever to collect wallet addresses linked to verified real-world identities in a structured way, this could be interpreted as operating identity infrastructure for transfers. The recommended mitigation is to keep wallet reputation scoring pseudonymous — scores tied to wallet addresses, not to real-world identity documents.

Jurisdiction	Framework	Teacat Status	Risk Level
EU	MiCA (Dec 2024)	Not a CASP — information layer only	Very Low
UK	PSRs 2017	Not a payment institution — no custody	Very Low
US	FinCEN / MSB	No US nexus required — Solana P2P	Low
FATF	Travel Rule	Not a VASP — no control over funds	Low (monitor)

Recommendation: Maintain the permissionless P2P architecture permanently. Do not introduce any escrow, fund-holding, or payment intermediary functionality without dedicated legal counsel in each target jurisdiction. The regulatory moat of the current architecture is itself a competitive advantage — Web2 competitors cannot replicate Teacat's zero-cut model without acquiring payment licences.

13. Narvi, "What is MiCA?", <https://narvi.com/blog/mica-eu-regulation>

7. Moat Dimension Deep-Dive

Network Effects

Teacat's network effects are currently single-sided. The Quadratic-Lite Matching Pool (Strategy 5) is designed to create multi-sided effects: each additional funder wallet increases the signal quality of the QF formula, making the pool more accurate at allocating matching funds to genuinely community-supported projects. This mirrors Gitcoin's core moat exactly, adapted for Solana and commercial products rather than Ethereum public goods.

Community Strength

Teacat's niche advantage — serving vibe coders specifically — is sharper than any competitor. The vibe coding builder community is reachable via identifiable channels (Lovable Discord, Bolt communities, IndieHackers, BuildSpace alumni) and is currently underserved by all existing platforms. Builder Leagues (Strategy 2) codify this community into a persistent on-platform identity that compounds monthly.

Trust / On-Chain Identity

This is where the on-chain model creates the most structural differentiation. Web2 platforms rely on brand reputation or document-based KYC for trust. Teacat's trust layer is cryptographically grounded — transaction history on Solana is immutable, public, and auditable. Wallet reputation APIs (Nomis, ChainAware, Fairscale) already score Solana wallets on 50+ signals with no friction for the end user.¹⁴ This is a trust mechanism that no Web2 competitor can replicate without fundamentally rebuilding their infrastructure.

Switching Costs

Builder League status (Strategy 2) creates status-based switching costs — reset on platform exit. The Intelligence Dashboard (Strategy 4) creates data-based switching costs — the benchmarking intelligence does not follow builders to other platforms. Together these mirror the two most durable switching cost types identified in platform economics research: relational/status costs and accumulated data costs.

Data Advantage

Gitcoin has accumulated six years of Ethereum QF signal. GitHub has 100M+ developer activity signals. Teacat's data advantage is in the vibe coding micro-project cycle specifically — campaign duration, funder wallet type affinity, optimal Solana-native launch timing for 2–8 week projects. This dataset is novel because the cohort did not exist at scale before 2025. First-mover indexing via Helius is critical before a well-funded competitor begins collecting the same signals.

14. Nomis, "Solana Reputation Score", <https://nomis.cc/scores/solana>

8. Key Risks & Mitigation

Risk	Likeli-hood	Impact	Mitigation
Bitcoin expands to Solana commercial products	Med	High	First-mover data moat; vibe coder identity layer specific to the cohort Bitcoin ignores
SOL/USDC price volatility deters funders	Med	Med	Support USDC stablecoin as primary donation currency; display amounts in USD equivalent
Solana network outage disrupts campaigns	Low	High	Helius 99.99% uptime SLA; implement graceful degradation — campaigns pause, not fail
Regulatory change reclassifies verification platforms as CASPs	Low	High	Monitor MiCA guidance updates; never hold or route funds; retain EU crypto counsel
Ko-fi or BuyMeACoffee adds Solana wallet support	Low	Med	On-chain capability is necessary but not sufficient — the vibe coder identity layer is the real moat
Wallet reputation APIs become commoditised	Med	Low	Teacat's proprietary score weighting and campaign-specific signals differentiate even if APIs are shared

9. Conclusion & Recommended Priorities

The revised Teacat architecture — \$5 micro-tip cap, permissionless Solana P2P transfers, Helius RPC verification — is structurally more defensible than the escrow model examined in the original report. It eliminates regulatory risk, reduces transaction costs to fractions of a cent, and grounds trust in cryptographic proof rather than brand reputation.

The competitive gap to close is not fees (already won) or regulatory position (already secured). It is on-chain identity, community recognition, and proprietary data intelligence — three assets that compound over time and cannot be replicated by Web2 incumbents without fundamental infrastructure rebuilds.

Recommended Priority Order

#	Strategy	Why First
1	Helius RPC Integration	Foundation for everything — no moat without on-chain verification
2	Vibe Coder Identity Layer	Lowest friction trust signal; enables all subsequent moats
3	Wallet Reputation Scores	Zero friction Sybil resistance — solves trust without eKYC
4	Builder Leagues	Status switching costs compound from day one
5	Intelligence Dashboard	Data moat begins; justifies future monetisation
6	Quadratic-Lite Matching Pool	Highest effort but creates the network effect that transforms scale

The Solana ecosystem is consolidating into the primary micro-payment chain — 67% of AI agent micropayments, Solana Foundation payments.org, sub-cent fees and sub-second finality.¹⁵ Whoever builds the trusted identity and discovery layer for vibe coding builders on Solana first occupies the same structural position that GitHub Sponsors holds for open-source — except in a faster-moving, commercially-oriented market that no existing platform is serving. The window is 12–18 months.

Report v2 prepared April 2026 by Perplexity Computer. Revisions: \$5 micro-tip cap model, Solana on-chain verification architecture, regulatory reframe, wallet reputation replacing eKYC. All competitive data sourced from public platform documentation and verified industry analyses.

15. Fystack / Solana Foundation, micropayment data,
<https://fystack.io/blog/why-solana-is-emerging-as-a-leading-chain-for-global-payments>